Participant Consent Form: Usability Study

Nov 3, 2026 · @dinky

Template note, delete before sending: fill in the bracketed fields and choose the study type. Send this form at least 48 hours before the session so people have time to read it and ask questions. For a confidential study, send the participant confidentiality agreement with it and get both signed before sharing any link. Have it reviewed by an attorney, and by your school if ethics review applies, before first use, because I'm not a lawyer.

Key facts

Please read this form before you agree to take part. The table gives the key facts, and the sections below give the details.

Item	Details
Study	A usability study of [Product name], run by Dayn Kirksey
Study type	[Open: anonymized findings may be shared publicly] or [Confidential: nothing is published, and you also sign a confidentiality agreement]
What you'll do	Try a few tasks on a prototype or test app and think aloud, online, for about [45] minutes
Recording	Only what you tick under "Your consent"; you can refuse all recording and still take part
Money	Test money only, so you never use or risk real money
Payment	[Amount and form], paid within [7] days, even if you stop early
Your identity	A participant code, such as P07, replaces your name in all notes and findings
Data kept	Recordings deleted within 30 days after analysis; contact details deleted 30 days after payment

Item	Details
Your rights	Stop at any time, skip any question, and ask to see or delete your data
Contact	Dayn Kirksey, [contact email]

1. What the study is and what you'll do

I'm testing whether [Product name] is easy to understand and use, so I can fix what confuses people before it launches. You'll join an online video call, or open a study link, and try a few tasks, such as reviewing a payment before you confirm it. I'll ask you to think aloud as you work, then ask a few questions and give you a short survey at the end.

I'm testing the product, not you. There are no wrong answers, and when something confuses you, that is exactly what I need to learn.

Adults 18 or older can take part. [Add any screening criteria, such as experience building AI agents.]

2. Risks, benefits and payment

The risks are low. You use only test money on a test network, so you can't lose real funds. The main risks are mild frustration with a confusing screen and the chance that something private shows on your screen, which section 4 explains how to avoid.

Never share a real secret. I will never ask for a real wallet's secret key or seed phrase, a password or any account login. Use only the test wallet or prototype I provide, and if anyone asks you for a real key, stop and tell me.

The benefit is indirect. Beyond the payment, you won't benefit directly, but your feedback will make the product safer and clearer for people who are new to crypto.

You're paid no matter what. You'll receive [amount and form] within [7] days of your session. You get it even if you stop early, skip questions or refuse recording, and it never depends on what you say about the product.

3. What I record and how I use it

Every recording is your choice. Under "Your consent" you tick only the recordings you agree to, and if you refuse them all, I take written notes instead. You can also ask me to stop recording at any point in the session.

What	Why	Used for
Your screen	To see where you click and where you get stuck	Analysis only, unless you tick public clips
Your voice	To capture what you say as you think aloud	Analysis, plus anonymized quotes if you tick them
Your face (camera)	Optional; it helps me read reactions	Analysis only, never shown publicly
Typed notes	Always taken, under your participant code	Findings
Survey answers	To score how easy the product felt	Findings, combined with other participants'
Clicks and timings in the test tool	To see your path and the time each task took	Findings, combined with other participants'

Findings are shared only without your identity. In an open study, I may publish anonymized findings in posts, the product's documentation and my graduate capstone, such as "4 of 5 participants missed the network name." I quote your words only if you tick that box, and never with your name, employer or face. In a confidential study, nothing is published.

AI tools are used only with your permission. In an open study, I use AI transcription or summaries only if you tick that box. In a confidential study, no AI tool ever processes your recording.

4. How I protect your data and identity

I collect only what the study needs. That means your name and email to schedule and pay you, your screening answers, the recordings you allow, my notes and your survey answers. I don't ask for your address, ID, date of birth or wallet details.

A code replaces your name. Every note, recording file and finding uses your participant code. The one list that links codes to names sits in a separate encrypted file that only I can open.

Your data stays locked down. Recordings and notes are stored on my computer with full-disk encryption, or in [study tool], which stores data in [region]. Only I [and named collaborators] can open them, and nothing is copied to other services.

Protect your own screen. Before the session, close email, chat, password managers and anything private, and turn off notifications. If something private shows anyway, tell me and I'll delete that part of the recording.

The tools I use follow their own terms. I use [video-call tool], [testing tool] and [survey tool] only to run the study, under their privacy policies and data processing terms. I never sell your data, use it for marketing or use it to train AI models.

If something goes wrong, I'll tell you. If your data is ever exposed, I'll tell you promptly, explain what happened and what I'm doing about it, and report it to the authorities where the law requires.

Data	Kept until	Then
Name and email	30 days after you're paid, or until you ask if you opt in to future studies	Deleted
Screen, voice and face recordings	30 days after the round's analysis, and never more than 90 days after your session	Deleted
The list linking codes to names	Deleted along with your contact details	Your remaining notes become anonymous
Notes and survey answers, under your code	Up to 2 years, for product decisions and my capstone	Deleted
This signed form	3 years, as proof of your consent, stored apart from study data	Deleted
Published findings (open studies only)	Permanently	Already anonymized

5. Your rights

Taking part is voluntary, and saying no has no effect on you.

- **Stop or skip.** You can stop at any time, or skip any task or question, without giving a reason, and you'll still be paid.
- **Change your mind later.** You can withdraw consent after the session, and I'll delete your recordings and notes, except anonymized findings already published and this signed form.
- **See, correct or delete.** You can ask for a copy of your data, a correction or deletion, and I'll respond within 30 days.
- **One limit.** Once the list linking codes to names is deleted, I can no longer find your notes, so they can't be deleted one by one, because by then they are anonymous.
- **Complain.** If you live in the EU or the UK, you can also complain to your data protection authority.

6. If this is a confidential study

In a confidential study you also sign a confidentiality agreement, which protects the product's information, while this form protects yours. Nothing from a confidential study is published, recordings never leave my encrypted computer, and no AI tool processes them. If the two documents conflict about your personal data, this form wins.

7. Questions and concerns

Ask me anything before you sign, during the session or afterward, at [contact email]. [If an ethics review applies: this study was reviewed by [review body], reference [number], and you can contact them at [contact] about your rights as a participant.] If you have a concern about how the study was run and would rather not raise it with me, contact [independent contact, such as a school research office].

Your consent

Tick each box you agree to. The first three are needed to take part, and every other box is optional, so leaving one blank changes nothing about your payment.

Needed to take part

- [ ] I am 18 or older.

- [ ] I have read this form, had the chance to ask questions, and agree to take part.
- [ ] I understand that I can stop at any time and still be paid.

Optional recordings

- [ ] You may record my screen.
- [ ] You may record my voice.
- [ ] You may record my face with my camera.

Optional uses, open studies only

- [ ] You may quote my words in published findings, without my name.
- [ ] You may use short clips of my screen and voice, with my face hidden, in public posts.
- [ ] You may use AI transcription or summaries on my recording.

Optional contact

- [ ] You may contact me about future studies.

	Participant	Researcher
Name		Dayn Kirksey
Signature		
Date		
Participant code	P__	

You'll receive a copy of this signed form.

Researcher's checklist (delete before sending)

1. Send this form at least 48 hours ahead, with the confidentiality agreement for a confidential study.
2. Assign a participant code when the session is booked, and keep the code list in a separate encrypted file.
3. Pre-fund the test wallet or open the prototype yourself beforehand, and never ask for a real key.
4. At the start, restate the key facts aloud, confirm the ticked boxes, and record nothing until the participant says yes on the call.

5. Ask them to close private apps and silence notifications, and turn off your own AI note-takers unless they opted in, which is never allowed in a confidential study.
6. Stop recording the moment they ask, and cut anything private that appears.
7. Pay within 7 days, whatever happened in the session.
8. Delete each item on the schedule in section 4, and log every deletion date in your research log.